



CONTACT

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☎ +31 6 2306 3073
in [linkedin.com/in/sabaza](https://www.linkedin.com/in/sabaza)
⊕ Available Worldwide
▣ Citizenship: Dutch

CORE CAPABILITIES

- › Client servicing & account management
- › Business development & strategy
- › Event strategy & creative direction
- › Commercial partnerships & sponsorship
- › P&L ownership & revenue growth
- › Leading large multidisciplinary teams
- › Production, technical & AV delivery
- › Logistics, marketing & ticketing
- › Global supplier network & multi-market delivery

LANGUAGES

Arabic	Native
English	Native
French	Excellent
Spanish	Excellent
Dutch	Working
Polish	Working
Portuguese	Basic
Italian	Basic
Romanian	Basic

INTERESTS

- › Basketball coach; former national youth player.
- › Travelled across 100+ countries.
- › Active use of AI in event production and planning.

Sherif Abaza

Global Events Director & Producer · 20+ Years · Strategy, Client Leadership & Live Experiences

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◆ Profile

Events leader who has built and run an events business, not only delivered events. Founded and scaled a 140-person agency to **USD 8M+ in annual revenue** — winning, servicing and growing the accounts behind it — and now advise brands, agencies and organisations on event strategy across three continents. 800+ events in 80+ countries, from festivals and competitions to international summits.

I work at both ends of the business. The strategic end: client servicing and senior account ownership, new business and pitching, commercial partnerships and sponsorship, budgets and P&L. And the delivery end that earns the right to it: creative direction, technical and AV production, site logistics, marketing, promotion and ticketing. I lead large multidisciplinary teams, and I am used to fixed timelines — dropped into a live project I map the critical path in week one: scope, budget, risks, owners and run-of-show. Nine languages, including fluent French.

◆ Professional Experience

Sphere Events and Communication · Dubai, UAE

Founder & Managing Director 2008 – 2018

- Grew the business from sole operator to a **140-person agency** exceeding **USD 8 million** in annual revenue — owning strategy, the new-business pipeline, pricing and full P&L.
- Owned senior client relationships end to end — brief, proposal, pitch, commercial negotiation and multi-year account growth — for **Siemens, Porsche, Cartier, Ericsson and Emaar**.
- Built the commercial model behind public festival franchises — **Street Nights, Marina Music Festival, Dubai Chocolate Festival** — aligning brand sponsors, mall operators and public stakeholders around shared commercial objectives.
- Directed those festivals for audiences of tens of thousands: creative direction, technical and AV production, site build and logistics, crowd flow and safety, marketing, promotion and ticketing.
- Delivered the **KitKat 3x3 basketball tournament (Sharjah, 2013)** and **esports tournaments and in-mall activations across Dubai (2014-2018)** — competition formats, broadcast and LAN production, sponsor integration and footfall-driven results for retail partners.
- Recruited, structured and led large multidisciplinary teams across production, technical, logistics, client servicing and talent — building the operating standards that let the agency scale.

Abaza Business Services • Global

Founder & Managing Director 2019 – Present

- Strategic advisor on event strategy, commercial partnerships and delivery for brands, agencies and organisations across three continents.
- Trusted delivery partner to leading global experiential agencies — **Jack Morton, Shelton Fleming** and **Impact XM** — representing them with their clients and leading their programmes on the ground.
- End-to-end delivery and on-site leadership for **COP27 (Egypt), COP28 (UAE)** and **COP29 (Azerbaijan)** — large-scale, multi-stakeholder events with multinational crews and immovable deadlines.
- **NBA** market launch support: event programme strategy for European and African market-entry initiatives with senior league stakeholders.

Withlocals B.V. • Eindhoven, Netherlands

Chief Community Officer 2022 – 2026

Chief Growth Officer 2018 – 2022

- As **Chief Growth Officer**, owned growth strategy and market prioritisation — scaling the business from 50 to **300+ cities across 80+ countries** using data-driven frameworks.
- Built the **B2B partnership framework**: deal structure, commercial terms, client onboarding and multi-year retention across enterprise accounts.
- As **Chief Community Officer**, led a 2,000+ partner community and directed the pivot to virtual experiences — **70+ corporate clients** won in under 90 days with zero ad spend.

FrontFlip (me360) • Kansas City, USA / MENA

CEO, Middle East & North Africa 2010 – 2015

- Held full commercial and P&L ownership for the region; **raised USD 1.8M** in early-stage funding and built a 35-person team across 6+ markets.

ASDAA Burson-Marsteller • Dubai, UAE

Senior Account Manager 2004 – 2006

- Client servicing and campaign strategy for **Siemens, Adidas and Hilton** across the Middle East — the grounding in account management that shaped everything since.
- Key role producing the **inaugural Dubai International Film Festival**.

Sundance Events • Dubai, UAE

Business Development & Operations Manager 2006 – 2008

- Built the client pipeline and supplier network for corporate and government accounts — the commercial foundation for founding Sphere Events.

◆ Leadership & Development

AIESEC International

Various Leadership Roles 1999 – 2004

- Progressive leadership including Local Committee President and National Support Team roles — leading cross-cultural teams and international exchange programmes.

◆ Education

Bachelor of Computer Engineering

Arab Academy for Science, Technology and Maritime Transport · Alexandria, Egypt